Patient Care Assistant (PCA)

Nursing · Nursing & Allied Health

Job title	Patient Care Assistant (PCA)	**Job code**	JD-HRM-086
Department	Nursing	**Division**	Nursing & Allied Health
Grade	FS1	**Reports to**	Head Nurse
Supervises	None	**SCFHS licence**	No

Job Summary

Provides basic non-clinical support to patients and nursing staff in the daily functioning of the assigned unit. Assists patients with activities of daily living, patient transport, unit supply management, and environmental maintenance under the direct supervision of nursing personnel. Contributes to a safe, clean, and comfortable patient care environment.

Essential Duties & Responsibilities

1. Assists patients with basic activities of daily living (ADLs) including feeding, personal hygiene, grooming, dressing, and toileting under the direct supervision of a PCT or registered nurse.
2. Assists with patient movement, repositioning, and safe transfer between bed, chair, stretcher, and wheelchair. Supports patient ambulation as directed, applying proper body mechanics and safety precautions.
3. Assists with bed making, linen changes, and maintaining a clean, safe, and comfortable patient environment. Ensures patient rooms are tidy and free of hazards at all times.
4. Distributes and collects meal trays. Assists patients with eating and drinking as directed. Ensures fresh water is available for patients. Reports any dietary concerns to the nursing staff.
5. Transports patients safely to and from diagnostic areas, clinics, operating rooms, and other departments as directed. Ensures patient identification and safety during transport.
6. Collects and delivers items, supplies, specimens, equipment, documents, and medications (sealed/packaged only) between the unit and other departments as directed by nursing staff.
7. Assists with room preparation for new patient admissions and post-discharge room clearance. Notifies housekeeping for terminal cleaning following patient departure.
8. Assists with the cleaning, organization, and storage of patient care equipment and supplies on the unit. Reports equipment malfunction or damage to the Staff Nurse, PCT, or Head Nurse.
9. Maintains stock levels of basic unit supplies (linen, toiletries, water jugs, cups). Assists in unpacking and organizing supply deliveries.
10. Observes patients and reports any changes in patient condition, behavior, or comfort level to the PCT or registered nurse promptly. Reports any safety or security concerns immediately.
11. Assists with the preparation of deceased patients (postmortem care) under the supervision of nursing staff, in accordance with hospital policy and with respect for cultural and religious practices.
12. Adheres to infection prevention and control practices including hand hygiene, standard precautions, proper waste segregation, and safe handling of linen and materials.
13. Communicates respectfully with patients, families, visitors, and all members of the healthcare team. Maintains patient privacy, dignity, and confidentiality at all times.
14. Follows all hospital-related policies and procedures. Participates in on-job training and development activities. Performs other related duties as assigned.

Qualifications: Education, Training & Experience

1. Education — High School Diploma or equivalent is required. Completion of a healthcare assistant or patient care aide training course is preferred.
2. Experience — No experience is required (on-job training provided). Previous hospital or patient care experience is preferred.
3. Licence / Certification — BLS certification is required (to be obtained within probationary period). No SCFHS licensure required. Saudi Nationals are preferred. Ability to communicate in Arabic and/or English is required.

Skills

1. Care Support: Basic patient-care, hygiene, mobility and comfort support.
2. Communication: Clear communication with patients and the nursing team.
3. Teamwork: Effective collaboration under RN direction.
4. Safety: Standard precautions, hand hygiene and safe patient handling.
5. Technology: Basic use of HIS/EMR data-entry and clinical devices.
6. Organisation: Task prioritization and documentation.

Knowledge

1. Basic patient-care support — hygiene, mobility, feeding and comfort under RN direction.
2. Vital-sign measurement, specimen transport and stock/room preparation.
3. Standard precautions, hand hygiene and safe patient handling.
4. Knowledge of GDIPC Infection Prevention & Control standards and hand-hygiene practice.
5. Knowledge of patient rights, confidentiality and the hospital Code of Conduct.
6. Knowledge of applicable KSA healthcare regulations relevant to the role.

Attitude & Behaviour

1. Respect & Integrity
2. Patient-Centred Approach
3. Accountability
4. Continuous Learning
5. Teamwork & Collaboration
6. Confidentiality
7. Professionalism
8. Adaptability & Resilience
9. Compassion & Empathy
10. Commitment to Safety

Physical Requirements

- Prolonged standing and walking during shifts.
- Ability to lift/assist patients and equipment (up to ~20 kg) with safe technique.
- Manual dexterity for clinical/technical procedures.
- Use of personal protective equipment (PPE); potential exposure to clinical hazards.

- Shift work, night shifts and on-call duties as required by the unit.

Approval

Reviewed & recommended by	Department Head	**Approved by**	HR Manager

Staff acknowledgement and signature are recorded electronically through the AMH Staff Credentials Portal.